

TECHNICAL SPECIFICATIONS

USGS RFQ 140G0126Q0132

Wildlife Satellite Tags

The USGS, Cooperative Research Units in Reston, VA, supporting the Ecosystems Mission Area requests the purchase of **20 (better than or equal to) PinPoint Argos Solar tags from Lotek Wireless Inc.** The primary use is to support the field program of the Idaho Cooperative Fisheries Research Unit for monitoring movements and nesting locations of Ridgway's rails in California to meet research objectives associated with endangered species research, contaminant risk, avian ecology, nesting success, and movement patterns.

The equipment must meet or exceed the following specifications:

- 1) Size requirements are most important; this is based on a biological tagging threshold principle of 3% body mass as a tag burden.
 - a. 6.6 g or less in mass
- 2) GPS enabled
 - a. This bird species can migrate and live in remote locations; therefore, we can't rely solely on VHF/UHF telemetry to collect locations
 - b. GPS provides more precise locations which allows for fine-scale tracking (e.g., can identify location of a bird nest and foraging locations)
- 3) Compatible with Argos satellite platform
 - a. Must be able to remotely deliver data (i.e., no base stations)
- 4) Customizable collection schedule (duty cycle) to account for seasonal changes to conserve battery
- 5) Backpack harness attachment style (i.e., attachment points at the front and back of tag or 4-corner hole casing)
- 6) Waterproof
- 7) Solar powered
- 8) Can operate at high environmental temperatures

Delivery Address:

US Geological Survey
875 Perimeter Dr MS 1141
Moscow, ID 83844

Delivery Timeframe: 30 days

Delivery Point of Contact: TBA

The USGS mission essential functions, involve providing information that supports decision makers and resource managers in the preservation of life, health and safety of the American people, and related information delivery systems for global monitoring and reporting. The resources identified in this procurement support research in endangered species conservation, avian ecology, and contaminant risks in wetland-obligate bird species and directly supports the educational training of graduate research students and the ability of the USGS to capture, process, monitor, report, and distribute scientific data in a timely manner. In making this procurement decision, USGS considered alignment with DOI IT Transformation goals, alternative solutions, bandwidth and IT security impacts, portability, interoperability, and life cycle requirements.